

Meeting Notes: Payments Reliability Quarterly Review

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Attendees

Payments Platform Engineering, SRE, Payments Product, Engineering Leadership.

Agenda

1. Review of Q3 payments incidents.
2. CNA connection pool remediation status.
3. Q4 reliability priorities.

Discussion

The team reviewed INC-2025-08-14-001 (payment gateway timeout) and INC-2025-10-02-002 (card authorization outage) in detail. Both incidents shared a common theme: capacity/resource limits not scaled to real production load, and both had clear, completed short-term remediations.

There was concern raised that the CNA connection pool fix was applied as a manual override rather than being enforced in infrastructure-as-code, creating risk of future config drift silently reintroducing the issue. Action assigned to Platform Engineering to convert this into a proper IaC change, though this was not completed by year-end (see INC-2026-05-11-005, which confirms this exact drift scenario occurred).

Decisions

- Q4 reliability priority #1: circuit breaker for PGW-to-CNA calls to fail fast rather than queue under connection exhaustion.
- Q4 reliability priority #2: synthetic transaction probe interval reduced across all payments services, not just CAS.
- Agreed to schedule a follow-up in November to check status of open action items from both incidents.

Action Items

1. Platform Engineering: convert CNA connection pool config to enforced IaC (carried over, still open as of this meeting).
2. SRE: implement PGW-to-CNA circuit breaker by end of Q3.
3. Payments Product: communicate Q4 reliability roadmap to customer-facing teams so support staff understand upcoming changes.